

JAPAN—EAST AFRICA CONNECTOR

Partnership Brief · First event: Tokyo, late November or December 2026

Connecting young people with companies, founders, institutions and one another across both regions.

WHO WE ARE

Japan-Africa Young Professionals (JAYP) is a community of young professionals and students, founded and led by Ryuma Kojima. Our aim is simple: help people stay connected after exchanges, internships and conferences, and build practical pathways to projects, careers, mentoring and collaboration across both regions.

THE PROBLEM WE FOUND

Japan—Africa exchanges, study experiences and one-time events create motivated people and valuable relationships — but contact usually ends when the programme ends. Young people with real experience, skills and ideas rarely have direct access to the companies, founders and institutions that could use them. African residents in Japan and Japanese people with African experience have few ways to meet one another across existing programme and community boundaries. What is missing is not another programme, but a practical, cross-programme connection point that helps people continue afterwards.

OUR APPROACH

The Connector is that continuation layer. We bring these groups into the same room and structure the conversation so people leave with specific connections, not just business cards:

- Continuity — a place to keep using relationships and knowledge gained through exchange, study, work or community activity.
- Concrete offers and needs — every participant and invited organisation arrives with a specific offer, request, idea, opportunity or challenge.
- Consent-based follow-through — we reconnect people only when both sides agree, then check in on what actually happened.

THE FIRST EVENT

When & scale	Tokyo · late November or December 2026 · a 2-hour facilitated evening · about 30–60 participants.
Who attends	African and Japanese students, young professionals, African residents in Japan, founders, companies, mentors, investors, universities and institutions.
What happens	Bridge Bingo introductions, welcome and context, two facilitated small-group rounds on backgrounds/goals and opportunities/needs, an opportunity board, and open networking.
What follows	Mutual-consent introductions handled within about two weeks, and one short 30-day check-in on meetings, applications, projects or other next steps. No public contact directory.

THE TWO-WAY PLAN

Tokyo is the starting point, not the geographic limit. Subject to named local co-leads and hosts, JAYP aims to co-design a related Tanzania-side event in summer 2027 and further Japan- and Africa-side events over time — expanding only where local ownership, purpose, audience and follow-through are clear. Investors are welcome, but investment is not the sole purpose and funding is not promised.

WHY PARTNER WITH US

We invite embassies, universities, companies, founders and Japan—Africa organisations to help shape a trusted first event and the longer-term bilateral model — through advice on the participant mix and relevant communities, participant referrals, introductions to organisations with genuine career, business, research or collaboration opportunities, a representative or brief opening remark, and, where feasible, venue guidance or a room. The most valuable support is trusted reach and practical insight, not a large cash commitment.

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Proposal for discussion. No partnership, funding, venue or endorsement is implied. Date, venue and participating organisations are not yet confirmed.